Extra Exercises 04 – Data Privacy in Everyday Life

AI Training for Beginners

Self-study training: use AI/LLMs safely in everyday life

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https://github.com/mgunthner/AI-Training

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Extra Exercises 04 – Data Privacy in Everyday Life

Cheatsheet: `01_cheatsheets/04_data_privacy_everyday`

Levels: ★ Getting started · ★★ Everyday · ★★★ Challenge **Rule:** Use only invented or anonymized data. All tasks work with any AI service and on a free plan.

Task 1 ★ – The postcard test

Scenario: You're wondering what to type into a chat.

Task: Sort each input: **OK**, **anonymize**, or **never**. - a) A poem you wrote yourself, for improvement - b) A customer's email with name and phone number, for answering - c) Your password for your email account - d) The question "How do I phrase a polite rejection?" - e) A photo of your ID card so the AI can fill out a form - f) Your neighbor's letter from the doctor so the AI can explain it - g) A vacation plan with desired destination and budget, without names - h) An internal price list from your company

Hint: Would you write it on a postcard?

Task 2 ★ – Tour of the settings

Scenario: You're not quite sure what your service does with your inputs.

Task: Open the settings of your AI service. Look for: use of data for training, deleting chat history, temporary chat. Note what exists and what you have set.

Hint: Not every service offers every option. If you can't find something, check the help pages or the vendor's privacy policy.

Task 3 ★★ – Anonymize and check

Scenario: You want the AI to draft a complaint. Your draft reads (all details invented):

```
Dear Sir or Madam, I, Erika Sample, residing at Sample Lane 7, 00000
Sampletown, booked a hotel in Sampleport on May 1 with the company
Travel World Sample (booking number BN-0000). The room was not as
described. I request a refund.
```

Task: Anonymize the text so that the AI can still improve it well. Enter it and check whether the result is usable. What do you have to insert yourself afterwards?

Hint: Give only as much as the AI needs for the task.

Task 4 ★★ – Screenshot check

Scenario: You want to upload a screenshot of your online calendar to the chat to find a free appointment slot. On the image you can see: your appointments for the week with names of people, an open browser tab showing your email inbox, your username in the top right corner, and the time.

Task: Name at least four things you should remove or redact before uploading. Describe how you could alternatively avoid using the image.

Hint: Even an image contains more than the area you want to show.

Task 5 ★★★ – The office dilemma

Scenario: Your supervisor says: “Just summarize the customer emails with AI, that’s faster.” You use a personal free account. You don’t know whether your employer has rules about this.

Task: 1. Write a short, polite reply to your supervisor (3–4 sentences). 2. Formulate three questions you would clarify beforehand.

Hint: Think about customer data, account type, and the role of the data protection officer.

Transfer Task Block A (optional) – My everyday life

Task: Choose a real everyday task (e.g. an email, a trip plan, or a study plan). Proceed as follows: 1. Choose the suitable model (topic 03). 2. Anonymize all details (topic 04). 3. Keep the chat limited to one topic (topic 02). 4. Check the result before you use it (topic 01).

In three sentences, note what went well and what you’ll do differently next time.

Suggested solutions

Task 1: OK: a, d, g. Anonymize: b (remove name and number, only if permitted). Never: c, e, f. On h: Company-internal information never belongs in a private chat without permission. If you have approval and a company account, it may be allowed, but only by agreement. On f: Never enter third parties’ health data.

Task 2: No fixed outcome. It's good if you have checked the training-data usage, set it deliberately, and know how to delete a chat.

Task 3: Example:

```
Write a polite but firm complaint to Company X.
I booked a hotel in Place Z on Date Y. The room did not match
the description. I request a refund.
```

Afterwards, you insert the name, address, booking number, and date yourself, outside the chat.

Task 4: Remove or redact: the names of people in the appointments, the email tab, the username, and if applicable location details in appointments. Alternative: type out the calendar with placeholders ("Appointment A, Mon 10 a.m.–12 p.m.") or crop to only the relevant section.

Task 5: Example: "Thanks for the idea! First I'll clarify whether we're allowed to use an approved company tool for this, because the emails contain customer data. Until then, I won't enter customer emails into personal AI services." Questions: Is there a rule about AI use? Is there a company account? What does the data protection officer say about customer data?